

The Midnight Cabal

Player-facing description

A whispered name for impossible jobs and doors that opened without permission.

Public role

Shadow-organization rumor and future-campaign seed

Handout text

The Midnight Cabal: a whispered future-thread name for impossible jobs and locked doors that opened anyway.

GM truth

GM-only future seed: leave the Cabal unresolved unless Kyle opens that arc at the table.

GM handling

Future thread only; a rumor, not a staged one-shot faction.

Mechanics

- Title: Faction Pressure / Reputation Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can read public face, negotiate leverage, track reputation, or identify pressure The Midnight Cabal when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: The Midnight Cabal is a rumor with a lockpick smile, present only in whispers and impossible coincidences. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-midnight-cabal-engage-the-midnight-cabal entity-the-midnight-cabal Engage The Midnight Cabal Engage The Midnight Cabal Presence Knowledge Instinct Presence Knowledge, Instinct 13 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Midnight Cabal hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Search Loot: The Midnight Cabal: a whispered future-thread name for impossible jobs

and locked doors that opened anyway.

Profile

- Schema Version: faction-profile-v1
- Id: the-midnight-cabal
- Entity Id: the-midnight-cabal
- Source: Faction_System_Packet/factions/WIDER_LORE_FACTIONS.md
- Priority: seed
- Corporate: False
- Atlas Lore Note: Atlas lore note: one-shot-safe expansion. Use as GM-only texture unless table play earns it.
- Auto Surface: False
- Prompt Key: courier
- Player Safe: The Midnight Cabal A whispered name for impossible jobs and doors that opened without permission. No slogan survives daylight. The Midnight Cabal is a rumor with a lockpick smile, present only in whispers and impossible coincidences. Nobody reliable claims to have hired the Midnight Cabal. That is part of the brand, if it is a brand. The stories always include one locked door, one unpaid debt, and one witness who insists the candle blew out by itself. The name is spoken the way people speak about a storm they hope will miss them. Quietly, with one glance toward the nearest door.
- Block1: The Midnight Cabal Midnight Cabal the midnight job A whispered name for impossible jobs and doors that opened without permission. GM-only seed: myth-armored operators in gaps the corporations cannot fully price. Future thread only; a rumor, not a staged one-shot faction. Unknown; useful as rumor pressure only. Unknown in this module. Their reputation is the lever, not a person on stage.
pages/entities/the-midnight-cabal.html the MID-nyte kuh-BAHL
- Block2: Shadow organization, not visible in the one-shot. Rumor, reputation, and the fear that a locked door is never fully locked. Unconfirmed. Their legend protects them better than a crest. Unknown; leave for future campaign confirmation. A name in whispers only. Do not stage them unless Kyle confirms the future arc. Institutional beliefs: Myth as Armor; The Job They Shouldn't Have Taken.
- Block3: No confirmed allies in this one-shot. Goldspire Logistics secrecy myth Unknown; do not answer in the one-shot.
- Block4: No slogan survives daylight. Black ribbon, wrong-side wax, unsigned notices, and a door that was locked when the party last looked. If the Cabal speaks here, it speaks as rumor: quiet, unverifiable, and too specific. A midnight keyhole hidden inside a crescent. Seed only: fingertips on shuttered glass.
- Block5: Future-campaign texture if players chase the system beyond the one-shot. Proof that the Board does not own every shadow, or proof that it wants people to think so. Unresolved by design. GM-only future seed: leave the Cabal unresolved unless Kyle opens that arc at the table. surface A whispered name. hint A rumor with one impossible detail. earned seam Future-campaign truth only. Do not stage. Let an NPC mention the name only if Kyle wants future-thread texture.
- Writing Layer: The Midnight Cabal is a rumor with a lockpick smile, present only in whispers and impossible coincidences. Nobody reliable claims to have hired the Midnight Cabal. That is part of the brand, if it is a brand. The stories always

include one locked door, one unpaid debt, and one witness who insists the candle blew out by itself. The name is spoken the way people speak about a storm they hope will miss them. Quietly, with one glance toward the nearest door. black ribbon, cold candlewick, wrong-side wax, shutter taps, and a keyhole that feels newly important a rumor too specific to dismiss and too theatrical to trust the chill of a story that wants you to repeat it rumor only in this one-shot future locked rooms, missing papers, and impossible exits, kept as rumor texture only No confirmed NPCs appear in this one-shot; any named contact remains a future Kyle confirmation. Goldspire...

- Entity Name: The Midnight Cabal

- Imagine It Like: Think the heist crew that is also an urban legend, the people who open doors that should not open, a master-thief myth whispered between jobs. (GM seed; do not stage without Kyle.)

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